

4-Digit Subtraction Exercise Sheet

Singapore Math Mental Strategies

Part 1: Decomposing by Place Value (Split Strategy)

Example: $6,785 - 2,341$

① **Decompose the subtrahend into place values**

Break the second number into thousands, hundreds, tens, and ones:

- $2,341 = 2,000 + 300 + 40 + 1$

② **Subtract the thousands**

Subtract 2,000 from the starting total (6,785):

$$6,785 - 2,000 = 4,785$$

③ **Subtract the hundreds**

Subtract 300 from the running total (4,785):

$$4,785 - 300 = 4,485$$

④ **Subtract the tens**

Subtract 40 from the running total (4,485):

$$4,485 - 40 = 4,445$$

⑤ **Subtract the remaining ones**

Take away 1 from 4,445 to get the final answer:

$$4,445 - 1 = 4,444$$

Practice Questions

1. $5,468 - 1,234 = 5,468 - 1,000 - 200 - 30 - 4 = 4,234$ 3. $6,543 - 2,132 = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$

2. $7,895 - 3,421 = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$

4. $8,976 - 4,515 = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$

5. $4,859 - 1,627 =$ _____

6. $9,684 - 5,241 =$ _____

7. $3,762 - 1,421 =$ _____

8. $7,594 - 2,361 =$ _____

9. $8,437 - 3,215 =$ _____

10. $6,985 - 4,152 =$ _____

11. $9,876 - 3,542 =$ _____

12. $5,964 - 2,313 =$ _____

13. $8,751 - 4,230 =$ _____

14. $6,849 - 1,527 =$ _____

15. $7,938 - 3,614 =$ _____

16. $4,675 - 2,143 =$ _____

17. $9,582 - 6,351 =$ _____

18. $8,694 - 5,172 =$ _____

19. $7,483 - 2,261 =$ _____

20. $5,796 - 3,425 =$ _____

Part 2: Compensation Strategy (Subtracting Near Thousands)

Example: $5,423 - 1,998$

① **Round the subtrahend up to the nearest thousand**

1,998 is close to 2,000 (it is 2 less than 2,000):

$$1,998 = 2,000 - 2$$

② **Subtract the rounded thousand**

Subtract 2,000 from 5,423:

$$5,423 - 2,000 = 3,423$$

③ **Add back the difference (Compensation)**

Since you subtracted 2 too much, add 2 back to the result:

$$3,423 + 2 = 3,425$$

Practice Questions

1. $6,315 - 1,997 = 6,315 - 2,000 + 3$
 $= 4,315 + 3 = 4,318$

6. $6,154 - 2,997 =$ _____
 $=$ _____

2. $4,582 - 1,999 =$ _____
 $=$ _____

7. $9,238 - 4,998 =$ _____
 $=$ _____

3. $7,246 - 2,998 =$ _____
 $=$ _____

8. $3,672 - 1,994 =$ _____
 $=$ _____

4. $5,831 - 1,995 =$ _____
 $=$ _____

9. $7,513 - 3,999 =$ _____
 $=$ _____

5. $8,419 - 3,996 =$ _____
 $=$ _____

10. $8,625 - 2,995 =$ _____
 $=$ _____